

Module 02: Agents — The Little Scientist

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **You** are an Agent (A Scientist!).
2. Learn that babies are the best scientists in the world.
3. Know that **Agency** means doing things on purpose.

Introduction: The Laboratory

To a baby, the whole world is a lab.

- "What happens if I drop this spoon?" (Clang!).
- "What happens if I pull the cat's tail?" (Meow!).
- "What happens if I taste this dirt?" (Yuck!). Babies aren't being bad. They are running **Experiments**. They are Agents trying to figure out how the world works.

Key Concepts

1. The Hypothesis (The Guess)

Before you act, you have a guess.

- "I bet that red ball tastes like a cherry."
- "I bet I can jump over that puddle." Your brain makes a prediction.

2. The Experiment (The Action)

You have to **Do** something to find out.

- You put the ball in your mouth.
- You jump! This is Agency. You change the world to test your guess.

3. The Data (The Result)

- The ball tastes like plastic. (Data!).
- You fell in the puddle. (Data!). Now your brain is smarter. You update your model.

Activities

Activity 1: The Spoon Drop

Watch a baby in a high chair (or pretend to be one). Drop a spoon. Does Mom pick it up? Drop it again. Does she pick it up again? You are testing the "Mom-Bot." You are controlling the system!

Activity 2: Sink or Float?

Fill a bowl with water. Collect 5 items (Leaf, Rock, Coin, Grape, Toy). Guess: Will it sink or float? Test it! Were you right? A good scientist admits when they guessed wrong.

Summary

We are all born scientists. By having goals, making guesses, and testing them with action, we discover the laws of the universe (and the rules of the house!).

References

- *Ada Twist, Scientist* by Andrea Beaty
- *Baby Brains* by Simon James